

THE DECCAN & THE MUGHALS (TO 1657)

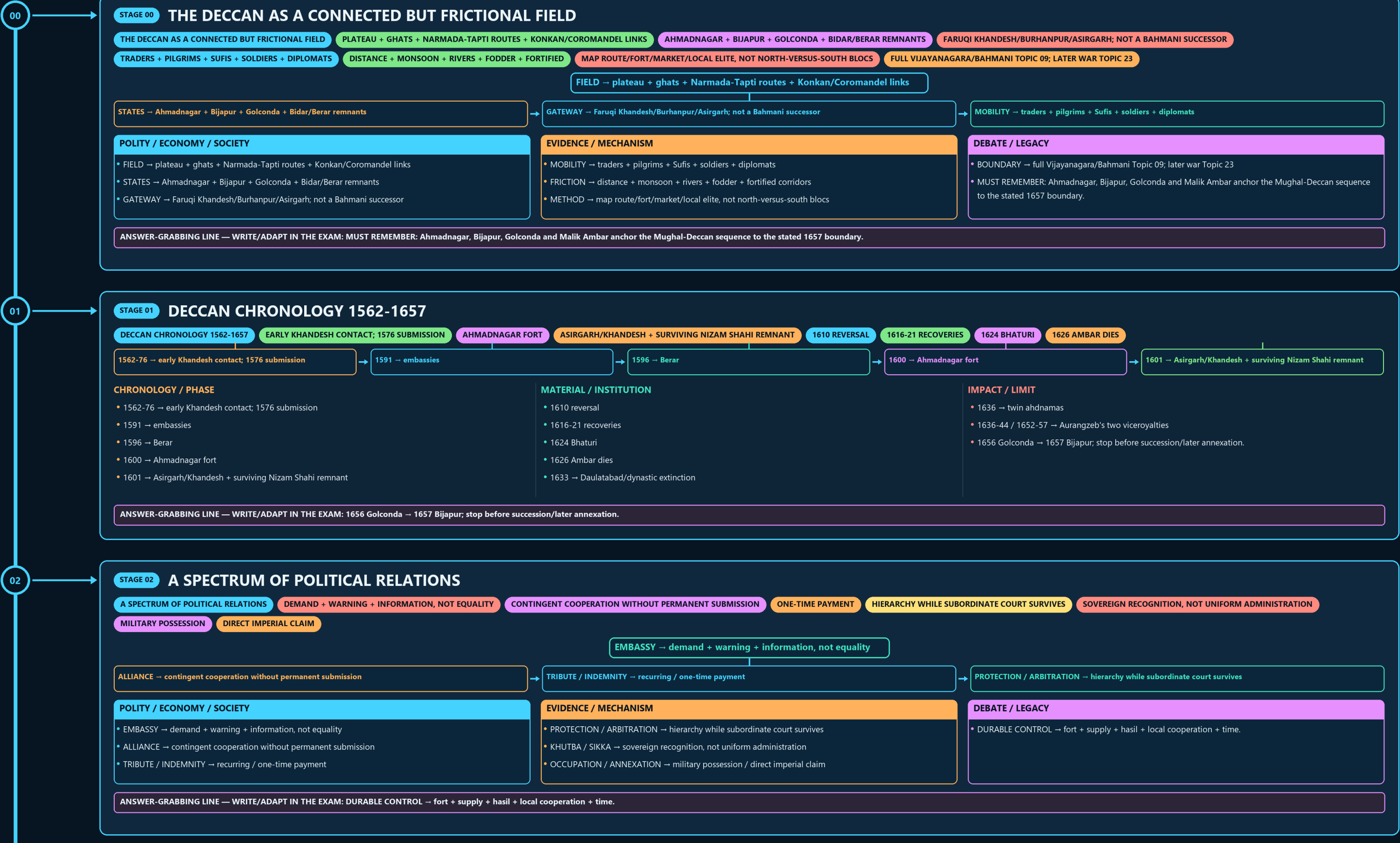
THE DECCAN AS A → DECCAN CHRONOLOGY 1562-1657 → A SPECTRUM OF POLITICAL → CHAND BIBI AND THE → AKBAR'S FOOTHOLD AND ITS → MALIK AMBAR'S RESISTANCE ENGINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g6 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



02

STAGE 02

A SPECTRUM OF POLITICAL RELATIONS

A SPECTRUM OF POLITICAL RELATIONS

DEMAND + WARNING + INFORMATION, NOT EQUALITY

CONTINGENT COOPERATION WITHOUT PERMANENT SUBMISSION

ONE-TIME PAYMENT

HIERARCHY WHILE SUBORDINATE COURT SURVIVES

SOVEREIGN RECOGNITION, NOT UNIFORM ADMINISTRATION

MILITARY POSSESSION

DIRECT IMPERIAL CLAIM

EMBASSY → demand + warning + information, not equality

ALLIANCE → contingent cooperation without permanent submission

TRIBUTE / INDEMNITY → recurring / one-time payment

PROTECTION / ARBITRATION → hierarchy while subordinate court survives

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EMBASSY → demand + warning + information, not equality

ALLIANCE → contingent cooperation without permanent submission

TRIBUTE / INDEMNITY → recurring / one-time payment

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

PROTECTION / ARBITRATION → hierarchy while subordinate court survives

KHUTBA / SIKKA → sovereign recognition, not uniform administration

OCCUPATION / ANNEXATION → military possession / direct imperial claim

DEBATE / LEGACY

DURABLE CONTROL → fort + supply + hasil + local cooperation + time.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DURABLE CONTROL — fort + supply + hasil + local cooperation + time.

03

STAGE 03

CHAND BIBI AND THE AHMADNAGAR CRISIS

CHAND BIBI AND THE AHMADNAGAR CRISIS

BURHAN/IBRAHIM DEATHS

RIVAL CLAIMANTS AND NOBLE COALITIONS

MIYAN MANJU

DECCANI COALITION INVITES MUGHALS, THEN RESISTS

CHAND BIBI

INFANT BAHADUR + HABSHI SUPPORT + BIJAPUR/GOLCONDA APPEAL

FOUR-MONTH DEFENCE

1595 → Burhan/Ibrahim deaths → rival claimants and noble coalitions

MIYAN MANJU → Deccani coalition invites Mughals, then resists

CHAND BIBI → infant Bahadur + Habshi support + Bijapur/Golconda appeal

1596 → four-month defence → Berar ceded + suzerainty + regency

1597 → combined recovery attempt defeated in Berar theatre

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

1595 → Burhan/Ibrahim deaths → rival claimants and noble coalitions

MIYAN MANJU → Deccani coalition invites Mughals, then resists

CHAND BIBI → infant Bahadur + Habshi support + Bijapur/Golconda appeal

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

1596 → four-month defence → Berar ceded + suzerainty + regency

1597 → combined recovery attempt defeated in Berar theatre

1600 → second siege + hostile-faction murder + fort captured

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: constrained regency and diplomacy, not lone romantic heroism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: constrained regency and diplomacy, not lone romantic heroism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: constrained regency and diplomacy, not lone romantic heroism.

04

STAGE 04

AKBAR'S FOOTHOLD AND ITS LIMITS

AKBAR'S FOOTHOLD AND ITS LIMITS

SOVEREIGNTY + KHANDESH ROUTE + REVENUE + INSTABILITY

CARTAZ/PILGRIM/COASTAL PRESSURE; CONTEXT, NOT SOLE CAUSE

BERAR + BALAGHAT + AHMADNAGAR FORT + ASIRGARH/KHANDESH

BURHANPUR LINKS PLATEAU, MALWA/GUJARAT AND AGRA-SURAT ROUTE

MURTAZA II/NIZAM SHAHI REMNANT RECOGNIZED AFTER 1600

GARRISON AND MAP CLAIM DO NOT SECURE COUNTRYSIDE OR

STRATEGIC FOOTHOLD AND SELECTIVE ANNEXATION, NOT WHOLE DECCAN.

MOTIVES → sovereignty + Khandesh route + revenue + instability

PORTUGUESE → cartaz/pilgrim/coastal pressure; context, not sole cause

GAINS → Berar + Balaghat + Ahmadnagar fort + Asirgarh/Khandesh

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

BASE → Burhanpur links plateau, Malwa/Gujarat and Agra-Surat route

LIMIT → Murtaza II/Nizam Shahi remnant recognized after 1600

LIMIT → garrison and map claim do not secure countryside or revenue

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: strategic foothold and selective annexation, not whole Deccan.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: strategic foothold and selective annexation, not whole Deccan.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: strategic foothold and selective annexation, not whole Deccan.

05

STAGE 05

MALIK AMBAR'S RESISTANCE ENGINE

MALIK AMBAR'S RESISTANCE ENGINE

RESTORED NIZAM SHAHI CLAIMANT + PESHWA OFFICE

HABSHI + DECCANI + AFGHAN + BIJAPURI AID +

RAPID MOVEMENT + INTELLIGENCE + PLUNDER + SUPPLY-CUTTING

LATER EVIDENCE

MEASURE/BOUNDARIES/RATES; IJARA

ZABTI TYPE

KHIRKI AND WATER/LOGISTICS SUPPORT; MATERIAL EVIDENCE BOUNDED

LEGITIMACY → restored Nizam Shahi claimant + Peshwa office

COALITION → Habshi + Deccani + Afghan + Bijapuri aid + Maratha bargis

METHOD → rapid movement + intelligence + plunder + supply-cutting

FISCAL → later evidence: measure/boundaries/rates; ijara → zabti type

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

LEGITIMACY → restored Nizam Shahi claimant + Peshwa office

COALITION → Habshi + Deccani + Afghan + Bijapuri aid + Maratha bargis

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

FISCAL → later evidence: measure/boundaries/rates; ijara → zabti type

URBAN → Khirki and water/logistics support; material evidence bounded

DEBATE / LEGACY

DATE → standard death 1626; one assigned OCR narrative prints 1627.

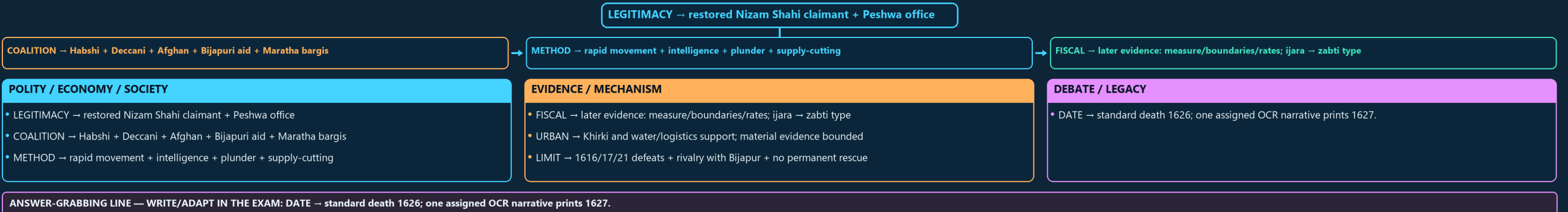
MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: strategic foothold and selective annexation, not whole Deccan.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: strategic foothold and selective annexation, not whole Deccan.

05

STAGE 05 MALIK AMBAR'S RESISTANCE ENGINE

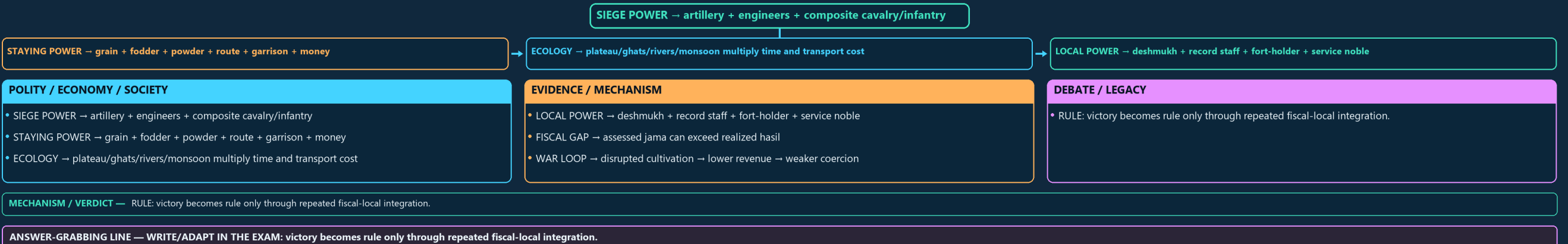
MALIK AMBAR'S RESISTANCE ENGINE RESTORED NIZAM SHAHI CLAIMANT + PESHWA OFFICE HABSHI + DECCANI + AFGHAN + BIJAPURI AID + RAPID MOVEMENT + INTELLIGENCE + PLUNDER + SUPPLY-CUTTING LATER EVIDENCE MEASURE/BOUNDARIES/RATES; IJARA ZABTI TYPE
KHIRKI AND WATER/LOGISTICS SUPPORT; MATERIAL EVIDENCE BOUNDED



06

STAGE 06 WHY CONQUEST DID NOT EQUAL CONSOLIDATION

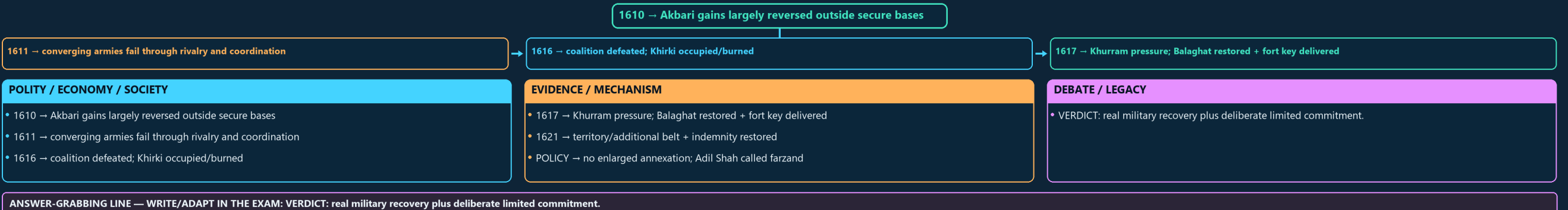
WHY CONQUEST DID NOT EQUAL CONSOLIDATION SIEGE POWER ARTILLERY + ENGINEERS + COMPOSITE CAVALRY/INFANTRY STAYING POWER GRAIN + FODDER + POWDER + ROUTE + GARRISON PLATEAU/GHATS/RIVERS/MONSOON MULTIPLY TIME AND TRANSPORT COST LOCAL POWER
DESHMUKH + RECORD STAFF + FORT-HOLDER + SERVICE NOBLE



07

STAGE 07 JAHANGIR: RECOVERY WITH RESTRAINT

RECOVERY WITH RESTRAINT AKBARI GAINS LARGELY REVERSED OUTSIDE SECURE BASES CONVERGING ARMIES FAIL THROUGH RIVALRY AND COORDINATION COALITION DEFEATED; KHIRKI OCCUPIED/BURNED KHURRAM PRESSURE; BALAGHAT RESTORED + FORT KEY DELIVERED
TERRITORY/ADDITIONAL BELT + INDEMNITY RESTORED NO ENLARGED ANNEXATION; ADIL SHAH CALLED FARZAND REAL MILITARY RECOVERY PLUS DELIBERATE LIMITED COMMITMENT.



07

STAGE 07

JAHANGIR: RECOVERY WITH RESTRAINT

RECOVERY WITH RESTRAINTAKBARI GAINS LARGELY REVERSED OUTSIDE SECURE BASES

CONVERGING ARMIES FAIL THROUGH RIVALRY AND COORDINATION

COALITION DEFEATED; KHIRKI OCCUPIED/BURNED

1610 → Akbari gains largely reversed outside secure bases

1611 → converging armies fail through rivalry and coordination

1616 → coalition defeated; Khirki occupied/burned

1617 → Khurram pressure; Balaghat restored + fort key delivered

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

1610 → Akbari gains largely reversed outside secure bases

1611 → converging armies fail through rivalry and coordination

1616 → coalition defeated; Khirki occupied/burned

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

1617 → Khurram pressure; Balaghat restored + fort key delivered

1621 → territory/additional belt + indemnity restored

POLICY → no enlarged annexation; Adil Shah called farzand

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: real military recovery plus deliberate limited commitment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT: real military recovery plus deliberate limited commitment.

08

STAGE 08

THE PRE-SHIVAJI MARATHA BRIDGE

THE PRE-SHIVAJI MARATHA BRIDGE

BARGI CAVALRY + DESHMUKH ROOTS + REVENUE STAFF +

AHMADNAGAR/BIJAPUR/MUGHAL EMPLOYMENT AND DEFECTION

MUGHAL RECRUIT

JAGDEV RAI + BABAJI KATE + UDAJI RAM +

MUGHAL MANSAB 5000/POONA JAGIR

FATH KHAN TRANSFER

CLAIMANT + BIJAPURI TROOPS + DISBANDED NIZAM SHAHI SOLDIERS

ROLE → bargi cavalry + desh mukh roots + revenue staff + diplomacy

SERVICE → Ahmadnagar/Bijapur/Mughal employment and defection

MUGHAL RECRUIT → Jagdev Rai + Babaji Kate + Udaji Ram + Bhonsales

SHAHJI → Mughal mansab 5000/Poona jagir → Fath Khan transfer → defection

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

ROLE → bargi cavalry + desh mukh roots + revenue staff + diplomacy

SERVICE → Ahmadnagar/Bijapur/Mughal employment and defection

MUGHAL RECRUIT → Jagdev Rai + Babaji Kate + Udaji Ram + Bhonsales

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

SHAHJI → Mughal mansab 5000/Poona jagir → Fath Khan transfer → defection

1633-36 → claimant + Bijapuri troops + disbanded Nizam Shahi soldiers

LEGACY → skill, local knowledge and confidence for later mobilization

DEBATE / LEGACY

LIMIT: no unified nationalist army or inevitable Shivaji state before 1657.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: no unified nationalist army or inevitable Shivaji state before 1657.

09

STAGE 09

DAULATABAD AND THE 1636 SETTLEMENT

DAULATABAD AND THE 1636 SETTLEMENT

KHAN-I-JAHAN ASYLUM MAKES INDEPENDENT AHMADNAGAR INTOLERABLE

FATH KHAN PUPPET + MUGHAL KHUTBA/SIKKA + SERVICE

MAHABAT KHAN TAKES DAULATABAD; RULING DYNASTY ENDS

SHAHJI RAISES CLAIMANT; BIJAPUR CONTESTS PARTITION

SUZERAINTY + 20-LAKH INDEMNITY + ARBITRATION + SHAHJI CONDITION

SHAH JAHAN KHUTBA + TRIBUTE FOR PROTECTION

BIJAPUR RECEIVES MAJOR FORMER AHMADNAGAR SHARE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
HARDENING → Khan-i-Jahan asylum makes independent Ahmadnagar intolerable	BIJAPUR → suzerainty + 20-lakh indemnity + arbitration + Shahji condition	BENEFIT → lower direct cost and temporary stability
1632 → Fath Khan puppet + Mughal khutba/sikka + service	GOLCONDA → Shah Jahan khutba + tribute for protection	LIMIT → compliance depends on trust, capacity and changing southern power.
1633 → Mahabat Khan takes Daulatabad; ruling dynasty ends	EXCHANGE → Bijapur receives major former Ahmadnagar share	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Campaign, treaty, tribute, elite defection and revenue logistics were linked but not interchangeable mechanisms.
RESISTANCE → Shahji raises claimant; Bijapur contests partition	FORM → partition + buffers + coercive hierarchy, not total annexation	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

HARDENING → Khan-i-Jahan asylum makes independent Ahmadnagar intolerable

1632 → Fath Khan puppet + Mughal khutba/sikka + service

1633 → Mahabat Khan takes Daulatabad; ruling dynasty ends

RESISTANCE → Shahji raises claimant; Bijapur contests partition

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

BIJAPUR → suzerainty + 20-lakh indemnity + arbitration + Shahji condition

GOLCONDA → Shah Jahan khutba + tribute for protection

EXCHANGE → Bijapur receives major former Ahmadnagar share

FORM → partition + buffers + coercive hierarchy, not total annexation

DEBATE / LEGACY

BENEFIT → lower direct cost and temporary stability

LIMIT → compliance depends on trust, capacity and changing southern power.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Campaign, treaty, tribute, elite defection and revenue logistics were linked but not interchangeable mechanisms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Campaign, treaty, tribute, elite defection and revenue logistics were linked but not interchangeable mechanisms.

10

STAGE 10

WHY THE 1656-57 COMPACT BROKE

WHY THE 1656-57 COMPACT BROKE

BIJAPUR/GOLCONDA EXPAND INTO KARNATAKA/COROMANDEL

MUGHAL-BACKED TWO-TO-ONE SHARING SHOWS ARBITRATION ROLE

DECCAN DEFICIT + INFLATED JAMA/WEAK HASIL + SUBSIDY DISPUTE

AURANGZEB/MURSHID QULI SEEK REVENUE AND TERRITORIAL RELIEF

MIR JUMLA

GOLCONDA RUPTURE + KARNATAKA WEALTH + MUGHAL SERVICE

COMPENSATION/TRIBUTE DISPUTE + RAMGIR; FULL ANNEXATION REFUSED

THE DECCAN & THE MUGHALS (TO 1657) • TILE 4/5 • same master rows 6946-10180 of 12496 • continues below

10

1000 → Mughal Khan Jahan's death; ruling dynasty ends

RESISTANCE → Shahji raises claimant; Bijapur contests partition

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HARDENING → Khan-i-Jahan asylum makes independent Ahmadnagar intolerable
- 1632 → Fath Khan puppet + Mughal khutba/sikka + service
- 1633 → Mahabat Khan takes Daulatabad; ruling dynasty ends
- RESISTANCE → Shahji raises claimant; Bijapur contests partition

1000 → Bijapur receives major former Ahmadnagar share

FORM → partition + buffers + coercive hierarchy, not total annexation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- BIJAPUR → suzerainty + 20-lakh indemnity + arbitration + Shahji condition
- GOLCONDA → Shah Jahan khutba + tribute for protection
- EXCHANGE → Bijapur receives major former Ahmadnagar share
- FORM → partition + buffers + coercive hierarchy, not total annexation

1000 → Mughal campaign; treaty, tribute, elite defection and revenue logistics were linked but not interchangeable mechanisms.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- BENEFIT → lower direct cost and temporary stability
- LIMIT → compliance depends on trust, capacity and changing southern power.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Campaign, treaty, tribute, elite defection and revenue logistics were linked but not interchangeable mechanisms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Campaign, treaty, tribute, elite defection and revenue logistics were linked but not interchangeable mechanisms.

11

STAGE 10

WHY THE 1656-57 COMPACT BROKE

WHY THE 1656-57 COMPACT BROKE

BIJAPUR/GOLCONDA EXPAND INTO KARNATAKA/COROMANDEL

MUGHAL-BACKED TWO-TO-ONE SHARING SHOWS ARBITRATION ROLE

DECCAN DEFICIT + INFLATED JAMA/WEAK HASIL + SUBSIDY DISPUTE

AURANGZEB/MURSHID QULI SEEK REVENUE AND TERRITORIAL RELIEF

MIR JUMLA

GOLCONDA RUPTURE + KARNATAKA WEALTH + MUGHAL SERVICE

COMPENSATION/TRIBUTE DISPUTE + RAMGIR; FULL ANNEXATION REFUSED

POST-1636 → Bijapur/Golconda expand into Karnataka/Coromandel

1646 → Mughal-backed two-to-one sharing shows arbitration role

FISCAL → Deccan deficit + inflated jama/weak hasil + subsidy dispute

1652-57 → Aurangzeb/Murshid Quli seek revenue and territorial relief

MIR JUMLA → Golconda rupture + Karnataka wealth + Mughal service

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- POST-1636 → Bijapur/Golconda expand into Karnataka/Coromandel
- 1646 → Mughal-backed two-to-one sharing shows arbitration role
- FISCAL → Deccan deficit + inflated jama/weak hasil + subsidy dispute
- 1652-57 → Aurangzeb/Murshid Quli seek revenue and territorial relief

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- MIR JUMLA → Golconda rupture + Karnataka wealth + Mughal service
- 1656 → compensation/tribute dispute + Ramgir; full annexation refused
- BIJAPUR → 1656 succession/arrears → 1657 invasion
- TERMS → former Nizam Shahi lands surrendered; state not annexed

DEBATE / LEGACY

- DEBATE → Aurangzeb presses conquest; Dara's decisive role unproven
- EFFECT → 1636 trust broken; direct-rule cost dilemma unresolved.
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Imperial annexation claims must be separated from durable control and from the agency of Deccani states and elites.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EFFECT → 1636 trust broken; direct-rule cost dilemma unresolved.

STAGE 11

TOPIC 18 FINAL ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 18 FINAL ANSWER SPINE

STATES + KHANDESH GATEWAY + FORT/ROUTE/MARKET ECOLOGY

AKBAR FOOHOLD

JAHANGIR RESTRAINT

1636 BUFFERS

VICEROY + JAGIR/JAMA-HASIL + LOCAL RECRUITMENT + LOGISTICS

MIR JUMLA/GOLCONDA 1656 + BIJAPUR 1657; STOP THERE

ABU'L FAZL/TUZUK/PADSHAHNAMA + FERISHTA + MARATHI/EUROPEAN/MATERIAL

DEFINE → suzerainty != tribute != garrison != annexation != control

MAP → states + Khandesh gateway + fort/route/market ecology

TRACE → Akbar foothold → Ambar → Jahangir restraint → 1636 buffers

APPLY → viceroy + jagir/jama-hasil + local recruitment + logistics

CLOSE → Mir Jumla/Golconda 1656 + Bijapur 1657; stop there

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- DEFINE → suzerainty != tribute != garrison != annexation != control
- MAP → states + Khandesh gateway + fort/route/market ecology
- TRACE → Akbar foothold → Ambar → Jahangir restraint → 1636 buffers
- APPLY → viceroy + jagir/jama-hasil + local recruitment + logistics

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CLOSE → Mir Jumla/Golconda 1656 + Bijapur 1657; stop there
- SOURCE → Abu'l Fazl/Tuzuk/Padshahnama + Ferishta + Marathi/European/material
- ADJ PYQ → 2020 GS-I Q12 Persian sources
- 2024 Prelims Q56 Bhatkal

DEBATE / LEGACY

- DIRECT PYQ → zero verified Topic-18 CSE routes, 2018-2026
- VERDICT → military leverage repeatedly outran durable fiscal-local control.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → military leverage repeatedly outran durable fiscal-local control.

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

PART V - ADVANCED EVIDENCE LABS

HOW TO REASON, NOT MERELY RECALL

LAB 1. READING A POLITICAL MAP WITHOUT TURNING IT

LAB 2. TURNING FACTIONALISM INTO EXPLANATION WITHOUT MAKING IT

LAB 3. CHAND BIBI AS A CASE OF CONSTRAINED

LAB 4. MALIK AMBAR

TESTING THE PHRASE 'RESISTANCE'

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- PART V - ADVANCED EVIDENCE LABS: HOW TO REASON, NOT MERELY RECALL
- Lab 1. Reading a political map without turning it into a modern border map
- Lab 2. Turning factionalism into explanation without making it a stereotype
- Lab 3. Chand Bibi as a case of constrained political agency

ADVANCED DEBATE

- Lab 4. Malik Ambar: testing the phrase 'resistance'
- Lab 5. Revenue claims: how to avoid false precision
- Lab 6. Shah Jahan's 1636 settlement as institutional design
- Lab 7. Why the 1656-57 breach was more than a new campaign

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Lab 8. A source-method answer can be a state-capacity answer
- Lab 9. Portuguese pressure: strategic context, not a diversion into maritime history
- Lab 10. Comparing three emperors without flattening policy into personality
- Lab 11. Annexation, revenue potential and realised control

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

THE DECCAN & THE MUGHALS (TO 1657) • TILE 5/5 • same master rows 9262-12496 of 12496 • end